RACHEL A. BRYANT

rabryant@uchicago.edu

Placement Director:	Manasi Deshpande	mdeshpande@uchicago.edu	(773) 702-8260
Graduate Administrator:	Kathryn Falzareno	kfalzareno@uchicago.edu	(773) 702-3026

OFFICE CONTACT INFORMATION

University of Chicago, Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
Saieh Hall for Economics
5757 S University Ave
Chicago, IL 60637

EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Ph.D. Economics *2021–Expected June 2027*

The Ohio State University, B.S. Economics, Honors, B.A. World Politics *2019*

REFERENCES

Esteban Rossi-Hansberg (Chair)
Glen A. Lloyd Distinguished Service Professor
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
rossihansberg@uchicago.edu

Erik Hurst
Roman Family Distinguished Service Professor of Economics
University of Chicago
Booth School of Business
erik.hurst@chicagobooth.edu

Milena Almagro
Associate Professor of Economics
University of Chicago
Booth School of Business
milena.almagro@chicagobooth.edu

RESEARCH AND TEACHING FIELDS

Primary: Trade, Spatial/Urban Economics
Secondary: Labor Economics, Public Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Geography of the Local Service Multiplier

Abstract: *State and local governments spend approximately $20 billion a year on firm-specific subsidies, rationalized by promised jobs and the corresponding local spending they generate. I study whether the spillovers that justify these awards materialize and whether the jurisdiction that pays for them captures them. I build a new matched sample of subsidized firms that separates the local and state cost of each award. I use linked employer-employee data from the Census to determine how large tradable firms source their workers. Using the observed residential location of the workers, I find service employment reallocates toward the neighborhoods where the firm's workers lived before entry. In commuting zones with no other observed events, tracts in the top quartile of worker exposure gain about X service jobs relative to the bottom quartile seven years after entry. A spatial equilibrium model for 55 promised-job events shows that incumbent crowd-out is small, so entrant jobs are generally net additions. One hundred entrant jobs support a median of 18 service jobs and add $2.14 million to resident welfare. Because workers commute and shop across county lines, the median host county keeps 52 percent of the service job gain. The place matters more than the firm, as the same plant supports between 8 and 26 service jobs per 100 entrant jobs across local economies. Spread over ten years, the length of the average award, the full award costs a median of $2,090 per net job each year.*

WORKING PAPERS

Who Benefits from Urban Place Based Policies? Evidence from Tax Increment Financing Districts (with M. Chen & E. Milstein)

Abstract: *We build the first comprehensive national evaluation of tax increment financing (TIF), a widely used but contested urban place-based policy in which cities freeze a district's assessed property value and divert incremental tax revenue into local development rather than general public services. Existing evidence is fragmented across single-city studies and narrow outcomes, leaving open whether TIFs generate new economic activity or merely relocate it, and who ultimately captures the gains. We assemble a new harmonized geospatial database of TIF districts covering the 100 largest U.S. cities and link it to CoreLogic data, public data, and Census microdata on the universe of firms and workers. Using staggered and stacked event-study designs around district adoption, we estimate effects on employment, residential property values, and service activity. We find meager employment growth within districts, but residential property valuation gains when projects support local amenities.*

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Buying the Neighborhood: Corporate Land Ownership and the Provision of Local Amenities

The Price of Local Ownership

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Social Science Division Fellowship, University of Chicago	*2021–2025*
Becker Friedman Institute Public Econ. Grant ($5,500) with M. Chen & E. Milstein	*2025*
Becker Friedman Institute Public Econ. Grant ($2,340)	*2024*
Gledhill Prize for the Best Undergrad. Applied Economics Paper	*2019*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Intl. Commercial Policy (MBA)	TA for Rodrigo Adão	*Spring 2025*
Intermediate Macroeconomics (U)	TA for Sergio Salas	*Spring, Summer 2024, 2025*
Intro. Monetary & Fiscal Policy (U)	TA for Sergio Salas	*Summer 2024*
Economics of Policy Analysis (U)	TA for Kanit Kuevibulvanich	*Spring 2024*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE AND OTHER EMPLOYMENT

Columbia Business School, Macroeconomics Group	*2019–2021*
Harvard Kennedy School, Evidence for Policy Design (EPoD)	*Summer 2018*
Brookings Institution, The Hamilton Project	*Spring 2018*

SERVICE

Cohort Representative, University of Chicago	*2021–2023*
Peer Mentor, University of Chicago	*2022–2023*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship	USA, U.S. Special Sworn Status to work with Census data
Programming Skills	Julia, Python, R, LaTeX
Languages	English (Native)

This version: October 25, 2026